have to give up everything even to my house and furniture and what perhaps vexes me more, my gun, horse and arms. This in fact I have offered to do if my creditors will give me a quittance which they as yet refuse to do.

*Tabreez, December 10, 1845*

I have been about sixteen days absent from Tabreez at Maranghd and the villages; and on my return here the 7th instt I found the monthly post had left the evening before. This was partly oweing to that slow man Dr. Cormick; he had come after me to the villages, and in returning, instead of riding thro' the eighty miles in twenty four or at most thirty or thirty two hours, as I usually do, we made four stages of it. I was much vexed, particularly as I am affraid since you are in the habit of receiving regular monthly letters from me you may be anxious at not hearing from me. I therefore send this by the post. You will have to pay for it but I believe now not much. I thought this better than waiting for the next monthly courier. I have written a long letter to you which is too heavy for this means of conveyance.

My journey to the villages was an agreeable one and they are going on very well, the farmers are breaking up much of the grass lands, which is a very good sign, because this, with their miserable ploughs is a most expensive and laborious process. I walked and rode about the grounds of the villages every day always accompanied by one or two of the farmers, and I learnt much about this mode of cultivation. The grass lands, they plough across and across, until they work out or destroy most of the weeds. They have no harrows, and I saw a piece of ground which had been ploughed over six times, and was still unfit for sowing. They smooth the ground by dragging over it a heavy plank of wood to which two oxen are yoked, and the man stands upon it. This breaks the clods: the seed having been first worked in with the plough.

I have not yet been to Tehran because Col Sheil now our envoy has again referred my case to the authorities at home, I believe the crown lawyers: he himself knows nothing of commercial matters. The Persians puzzle him, and he is affraid to act. My own position is much the same as formerly except that I am more comfortable. I have made something from the villages, am well with the Prince, and I may say pretty generally respected, — and being much in the Prince's confidence gives me a position with the people attached to this court which I did not enjoy even when I was a thriving merchant.

The experiment on the salt lands has not succeeded, the deeper I dug the salter the earth was; until I came to the sea sand or rather lake sand and salt water. Now as this plan has not succeeded here perhaps the Persian method may in England. That is by turning a stream of fresh water over land and banking

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